

Advanced Connectors

B2 · Upper-Intermediate · Formal, written-style connectors for contrast, addition, and consequence.

You already know but/so/because. This lesson gives you the more formal connectors used in essays, reports, and professional writing.

Rules

a) Contrast

- **whereas** (neutral contrast, joining two clauses): The north is mountainous, whereas the south is flat.
- **despite / in spite of** + noun/gerund: Despite the rain, we went out. / In spite of losing, they stayed positive.
- **nevertheless** (starts a new sentence): The plan was risky. Nevertheless, they went ahead.

b) Addition

- **furthermore / moreover** (adds a stronger point, formal, starts a new sentence): The product is expensive. Furthermore, it's poorly made.

c) Consequence

- **consequently / as a result** (formal result, starts a new sentence): Sales fell sharply. Consequently, the company cut costs.

Examples

- The north is mountainous, whereas the south is flat.
- Despite the rain, we went out.
- The plan was risky. Nevertheless, they went ahead.
- The product is expensive. Furthermore, it's poorly made.
- Sales fell sharply. Consequently, the company cut costs.
- In spite of losing, the team stayed positive.

Common Mistakes

× Despite it was raining, we went out.

✓ Despite the fact that it was raining, we went out. / Despite the rain, we went out.

"Despite" takes a noun or gerund, not a full clause directly.

✗ The plan was risky, nevertheless they went ahead.

✓ The plan was risky. Nevertheless, they went ahead.

"Nevertheless" typically starts a new sentence, with a period before it, not a comma joining one sentence.

✗ The report is late, furthermore is incomplete.

✓ The report is late. Furthermore, it is incomplete.

"Furthermore" needs its own clause with a subject ("it"), not a fragment.

Summary

- Whereas = neutral contrast joining two clauses. Despite/in spite of + noun/gerund = contrast.
- Furthermore/moreover = formal addition. Nevertheless = formal contrast, new sentence.
- Consequently/as a result = formal consequence, new sentence.

Renan the Teacher — English Language Academy ·

renangrossi.github.io/englishclasses